



Noukclass.com

NCE Predicted Examination Paper — 2026

2026

ENGLISH

GRADE 9 • PAPER 2 OF 4

Time Allowed: **2 hours 15 minutes**

Total Marks: **100**

Candidate Name: _____

School: _____

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Read all instructions carefully before you begin.
2. Answer **ALL** questions in Sections A, B and D.
3. In Section C (Writing), answer **ONE** task only.
4. Write your answers in the spaces provided.
5. The marks available for each question are shown in a box [].
6. Use blue or black ink. Pencil may be used for diagrams only.
7. Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

Section	Topic	Available	Obtained
A	Reading Comprehension	30	
B	Language Use	25	
C	Writing	30	
D	Vocabulary & Word Study	15	
TOTAL		100	

SECTION A — READING COMPREHENSION [30 marks]

Read the passage carefully, then answer **ALL** the questions that follow.

Rising Waters: Climate Change and the Future of Small Island Nations

For the inhabitants of small island nations such as Mauritius, the Maldives, and Tuvalu, climate change is not a distant threat to be debated in conference rooms — it is a lived, daily reality. Scientists now warn that without dramatic reductions in global greenhouse gas emissions, many low-lying islands could face partial or total submersion by the end of this century, displacing millions of people and erasing cultures that have existed for thousands of years.

The primary driver of this crisis is the burning of fossil fuels — coal, oil, and natural gas — which releases carbon dioxide and other greenhouse gases into the atmosphere. These gases act like a blanket around the Earth, trapping heat and causing global temperatures to rise. The consequences are far-reaching: glaciers melt, sea levels climb, weather patterns shift, and extreme events such as cyclones, droughts, and floods become more frequent and more severe.

For island communities, the effects are already painfully visible. Coastal erosion is swallowing beaches and farmland. Coral reefs — vital ecosystems that protect coastlines and support fisheries — are bleaching and dying as ocean temperatures rise. Freshwater supplies are becoming contaminated with saltwater as seas encroach further inland. In some Pacific islands, entire villages have already been relocated to higher ground, a process that uproots families, destroys livelihoods, and severs communities from the ancestral lands that define their identity.

Critics of strong climate action often argue that the economic cost of transitioning away from fossil fuels is too high, particularly for developing nations. However, economists increasingly warn that the cost of *inaction* will be far greater. The World Bank estimates that without intervention, climate

change could push over 200 million people into internal migration by 2050, creating enormous social and economic pressures that no government will be able to ignore.

The good news is that solutions exist. Renewable energy technologies — solar, wind, and tidal power — have fallen dramatically in price over the past decade and are now competitive with fossil fuels in many markets.

Reforestation programmes, sustainable agriculture, and improved coastal defences can all contribute to building resilience. What is required, above all else, is the political will to act before the point of no return is reached. For the people of the world's smallest island nations, that time is already running out.

1. Name **TWO** small island nations mentioned in the passage that face serious threats from climate change. [1]

2. According to paragraph 2, what causes global temperatures to rise? Explain the process described by the writer. [2]

3. Describe **THREE** specific effects of climate change on island communities mentioned in paragraph 3. [3]

(a)

(b)

(c)

4. What does the phrase "*severs communities from the ancestral lands that define their identity*" (paragraph 3) mean? Explain in your own words. [2]

5. Find a word in **paragraph 2** that means "*having effects or consequences that spread widely.*" [1]

6. Find a word in **paragraph 3** that means "*moving gradually into or encroaching upon.*" [1]

7. How does the writer respond to critics who argue that tackling climate change is too expensive? Use evidence from the passage. [2]

8. What solutions does the writer suggest in paragraph 5? Identify **THREE** and explain how each helps address climate change. [3]

9. How does the writer use language to persuade the reader that urgent action on climate change is necessary? In your answer, discuss the writer's use of:

- facts and statistics
- emotive language
- structure

[5]

10. *"Wealthy nations have a moral duty to compensate small island countries for the damage caused by climate change."*

[10]

Do you agree? Use **evidence from the passage** and your **own ideas** to support your answer. Write approximately 150–200 words.

SECTION B — LANGUAGE USE [25 marks]

Answer **ALL** questions in this section.

Part 1 — Active and Passive Voice [5 marks]

Rewrite each sentence by changing from **active to passive** or **passive to active** as instructed. Do **not** change the tense.

11. *Climate scientists have issued urgent warnings about rising sea levels.* [Change to **passive**]

[1]

12. *Several villages were relocated to higher ground by the government last year.* [Change to **active**]

[1]

13. *Factories around the world release millions of tonnes of carbon dioxide every year.* [Change to **passive**]

[1]

14. *New solar panels are being installed on school rooftops across the country.* [Change to **active**]

[1]

15. *The international committee will present its final climate report next week.* [Change to **passive**]

[1]

Part 2 — Reported Speech [5 marks]

Change each sentence into **reported speech**. Begin with the words given.

16. *"We must reduce our carbon emissions immediately," said the scientist.* [1]
The scientist said _____
17. *"Our island will be uninhabitable within fifty years if nothing changes," warned the prime minister.* [1]
The prime minister warned _____
18. *"Are you doing anything to reduce your household's carbon footprint?" the journalist asked the family.* [1]
The journalist asked the family _____
19. *"Renewable energy prices have fallen by over 80% in the past decade," the economist explained.* [1]
The economist explained _____
20. *"You should plant more trees in your neighbourhood," the environmental officer advised the students.* [1]
The environmental officer advised the students

Part 3 — Conditionals [5 marks]

Complete each sentence using the correct form of the verb in brackets.

21. If countries _____ (reduce) their greenhouse gas emissions now, global temperatures would rise more slowly. (2nd conditional) [1]
22. If world leaders had acted decisively in the 1990s, many coastal communities _____ (not / lose) their land. (3rd conditional) [1]
23. Unless industrialised nations _____ (cut) their emissions significantly, island nations will continue to suffer disproportionately. [1]
24. If the government _____ (invest) more in renewable energy, thousands of new jobs would be created. (2nd conditional) [1]
25. The coral reefs would not have bleached so severely had ocean temperatures _____ (not / rise) so rapidly. (3rd conditional) [1]

Part 4 — Connectives [5 marks]

Choose the most appropriate connective from the box to complete each sentence. Each word is used **once only**.

furthermore | nevertheless | as a result | although | in contrast

26. Sea levels have risen by approximately 20 centimetres since 1900; _____, the rate of rise is accelerating. [1]
27. _____ some countries have increased their use of renewable energy, global emissions are still rising overall. [1]
28. Wealthy industrialised nations produce the most greenhouse gases. _____, small island nations, which produce very little, suffer the worst consequences. [1]
29. Deforestation destroys biodiversity; _____, it also releases vast quantities of stored carbon into the atmosphere. [1]
30. The talks were declared a failure by several delegates; _____, a landmark agreement was signed on the final day. [1]

Part 5 — Tenses [5 marks]

Fill in each blank with the correct form of the verb in brackets.

31. By 2050, scientists predict that sea levels _____ (rise) by at least half a metre compared to current levels. [1]
32. The coral reefs around this island _____ (bleach) every summer for the past five years. [1]
33. When the storm struck last night, the coastal barriers _____ (already / breach) by earlier flooding. [1]
34. The government _____ (currently / negotiate) a new international agreement on carbon reduction. [1]
35. The fisherman _____ (fish) in these waters for thirty years before the reef collapsed. [1]

SECTION C — WRITING [30 marks]

Choose **ONE** task only. Write between **250 and 350 words**. Plan your answer before you write.

TASK A — Formal Letter

Write a **formal letter** to a national newspaper arguing that your government should do more to protect the environment. Your letter should include a clear statement of your concern, specific examples of environmental problems, realistic proposals for action, and a call to your readers to take part.

TASK B — Discursive Essay

Write a **discursive essay** with the title: *"Individuals, not governments, are responsible for solving the climate crisis."* Present both sides of the argument clearly, with relevant examples, before reaching a justified conclusion that reflects your own view.

TASK C — Creative Writing

Write a **short story** set fifty years in the future, when the effects of climate change have become catastrophic. Your story should be told through the eyes of a young person living in this world. Focus on vivid description and the emotional impact on your character.

Task chosen (circle): **A** **B** **C**

Blank lined paper with horizontal ruling lines.

SECTION D — VOCABULARY AND WORD STUDY [15 marks]

Part 1 — Collocations [5 marks]

Choose the word that best completes each collocation. Circle the correct option.

36. We need to **reduce / lower / shrink** our carbon **footprint / trace / shadow**. [1]
(Choose one word from each pair)

37. The country plans to **achieve / reach / arrive at** carbon **neutrality / equality / balance** by 2040. [1]
(Choose one word from each pair)

38. Scientists say we must **tackle / handle / meet** climate change before it is too late. [1]
Answer: _____

39. The new policy **raises / lifts / heightens** awareness of the dangers of plastic pollution. [1]
Answer: _____

40. Communities along the coast must build **resilience / resistance / endurance** to extreme weather events. [1]
Answer: _____

Part 2 — Word Forms [5 marks]

Complete the table by writing the missing word form in each **shaded cell**. One mark per correct answer.

Verb	Noun	Adjective
pollute		polluted / polluting
	conservation	conservative / conserved
destroy	destruction	
	resilience	resilient

sustain		sustainable
---------	--	-------------

[5 marks: 1 mark per shaded cell]

Part 3 — Phrasal Verbs in Context [5 marks]

Choose the correct phrasal verb from the box to complete each sentence. Use each phrasal verb **once only**. Change the form where necessary.

run out of | give up | take up | build up | wipe out

41. Scientists fear that continued deforestation will _____ entire species that have lived in the rainforest for millions of years. [1]
42. If we continue at this rate, we will _____ our planet's natural resources within this century. [1]
43. Carbon dioxide _____ in the atmosphere over many decades, trapping more and more heat. [1]
44. Many young people have _____ cycling to school as a way of reducing their personal carbon emissions. [1]
45. Despite the scale of the challenge, environmental campaigners refuse to _____ hope for a sustainable future. [1]

MARK SCHEME — Paper 2 (Environment / Climate Change)

For teacher / examiner use. Accept any answer that is clearly correct in meaning. Where own words are required, do not award marks for direct quotation unless stated. Apply the writing grid for Q10 and Section C.

Q	Acceptable Answer(s)	Mark
1	Any two from: Mauritius, the Maldives, Tuvalu. (1 mark for any two correct.)	1
2	The burning of fossil fuels releases greenhouse gases (CO ₂). These gases trap heat in the atmosphere like a blanket around the Earth, causing global temperatures to rise. (1 mark for identifying fossil fuels/greenhouse gases; 1 mark for the "blanket" effect / heat-trapping mechanism.)	2
3	Any three from: (a) Coastal erosion destroying beaches and farmland. (b) Coral reefs bleaching and dying. (c) Freshwater contaminated by saltwater. (d) Entire villages being relocated. (1 mark each, clearly stated.)	3
4	It means that communities are cut off / separated from the land where their ancestors lived — the land that gives them their sense of who they are and where they belong. (1 mark for "cut off from ancestral land"; 1 mark for explaining why this matters — identity / sense of belonging.)	2
5	far-reaching	1
6	encroach (accept: encroaches)	1
7	The writer counters by arguing that inaction will cost far more — citing the World Bank estimate that over 200 million people could be forced to migrate internally by 2050, creating enormous social and economic pressure. (1 mark for the counter-argument position; 1 mark for the specific statistic / World Bank evidence.)	2
8	Any three from: Renewable energy (solar/wind/tidal) — provides clean power to replace fossil fuels. Reforestation — absorbs CO ₂ ; and restores ecosystems. Sustainable agriculture — reduces emissions from food production. Improved coastal defences — protects communities from flooding and erosion. (1 mark per solution clearly explained.)	3
9	Award up to 5 marks: Facts/statistics [1–2]: e.g. "200 million people" / "80% fall in renewable energy prices" — lend authority and urgency. Emotive language [1–2]: e.g. "erasing cultures," "severs communities," "running out" — creates emotional appeal and a sense of loss. Structure [1]: Builds from problem (paragraphs 1–4) to solution (paragraph 5) with a final warning, suggesting urgency but also hope. Credit specific textual references and analysis of effect.	5
10	Extended response grid (10 marks): Content & argument [4]: Addresses the statement; uses passage evidence; adds own ideas; reaches a clear position.	10

	Organisation [3]: Clear structure; logical paragraphing; effective connectives. Language [3]: Accurate grammar and spelling; varied vocabulary; appropriate discursive register.	
Section B — Language Use		
11	Urgent warnings about rising sea levels have been issued by climate scientists.	1
12	The government relocated several villages to higher ground last year.	1
13	Millions of tonnes of carbon dioxide are released by factories around the world every year.	1
14	Workers / the school / the local authority are installing new solar panels on school rooftops across the country. (Accept any logical subject.)	1
15	The final climate report will be presented by the international committee next week.	1
16	The scientist said (that) they must / had to reduce their carbon emissions immediately.	1
17	The prime minister warned (that) their island would be uninhabitable within fifty years if nothing changed.	1
18	The journalist asked the family if / whether they were doing anything to reduce their household's carbon footprint.	1
19	The economist explained (that) renewable energy prices had fallen by over 80% in the past decade.	1
20	The environmental officer advised the students to plant more trees in their neighbourhood.	1
21	reduced	1
22	would not have lost	1
23	cut	1
24	invested	1
25	not risen	1
26	furthermore	1
27	Although	1
28	In contrast	1
29	furthermore	1
30	nevertheless	1
31	will have risen	1
32	have been bleaching / have bleached	1
33	had already been breached	1
34	is currently negotiating	1
35	had been fishing	1

Section C — Writing (30 marks)		
C	Content & Task Fulfilment [12]: Task fully addressed; correct form; sufficient detail and development. Organisation & Structure [9]: Clear introduction and conclusion; logical paragraphing; effective connectives. Language & Style [9]: Accurate grammar, punctuation and spelling; varied sentences and vocabulary; appropriate register.	30
Section D — Vocabulary & Word Study		
36	reduce / carbon footprint	1
37	achieve / carbon neutrality	1
38	tackle	1
39	raises	1
40	resilience	1
Word forms	Row 1: pollution . Row 2: conserve . Row 3: destructive . Row 4: build / develop (verb). Row 5: sustainability .	5
41	wipe out	1
42	run out of	1
43	builds up	1
44	taken up	1
45	give up	1